

■ Factor

`Factor[poly]` factorizes a polynomial over the integers.

`Factor[poly, Modulus->p]` factorizes a polynomial modulo a prime p .

`Factor` applies only to the top level in an expression. You may have to use `Map`, or apply `Factor` again, to reach other levels. ■ `Factor[poly, Variables->{ $x_1$ ,  $x_2$ , ...}]` allows you to specify an ordering on the variables in *poly*. The time needed to do the factorization may depend on the ordering you specify. ■ `Factor` works only with exact `Integer` or `Rational` coefficients, not with `Real` numbers. ■ The exponents of variables need not be positive integers. `Factor` can deal with exponents that are linear combinations of symbolic expressions. ■ See page 381. ■ See also: `FactorTerms`, `Solve`, `Expand`, `Simplify`, `FactorInteger`.